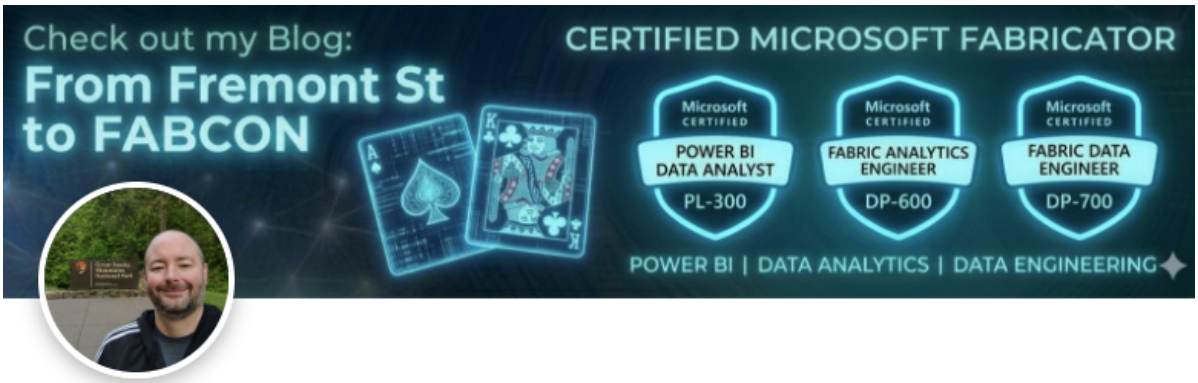


Jeff Shoemaker
Ready to Translate Fabric Strategy into Scalable Business Goals | Microsoft Reactor Moderator | Senior Data Support Engineer — Casino Systems

IGT

The University of Texas at Arlington

DP-800 - SQL AI Developer Associate - Overview

The DP-800 (Developing AI-Enabled Database Solutions) exam, Generally Available in May 2026, marks a massive shift in how Microsoft certifies database professionals. It targets the intersection of core database programming, modern DevOps, and in-database Generative AI

How DP-800 Relates to Past SQL Developer Exams

For years, Microsoft lacked a dedicated, pure development exam for SQL Server professionals after retiring legacy paths. The DP-800 acts as a modern reincarnation of those classic developer certs, but with an AI twist

Detailed Target Audience

- **Designed for:** Relational database professionals who want to build intelligent applications without moving their data to external machine learning pipelines.
- **Roles:** SQL Developers, DBAs, Cloud Database Engineers, Data Solutions Architects.
- **Focus:** Writing advanced T-SQL, managing vector data types, implementing vector search, and executing Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) entirely inside the database engine.
- **Best for:** Professionals who want to ride the AI wave using their existing, strong relational database skills instead of pivoting fully into full-stack data science.

DP-800 - SQL AI Developer Associate – Study Plan

Microsoft DP-800 Overview

- https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/dp-800
- Breaks down the exam based on sections
- Good starting point to begin your study journey
- Note the Change log to see if areas are updating by the time you take the exam. There may be a delay on changes vs content being adjusted

Bob Ward - SQL Server 2025 Unveiled Book

- https://www.amazon.com/SQL-Server-2025-Unveiled-Integration/dp/B0FH1P9B2Y
- Good introduction to the material
- Includes scripts to illustrate topics discussed

Microsoft Study Guide

- https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/collections/kw3oh2td0qzw1j
- Modules are broken up into the Key Topics of the Exam
- Questions are based on high level concepts

Kulijot Bakshi's Udemy DP-800 Course

- https://www.udemy.com/course/microsoft-sql-ai-developer-associate/?couponCode=DP800COURSELAUNCH
- Easy to understand modules
- Great hands-on labs

Phillip Burton's Udemy DP-800 Course

- https://www.udemy.com/course/dp-800-exam-prep-microsoft-sql-server-ai-developer/?couponCode=LAUNCHMAY26
- Content is updated frequently
- A great supplement to Kuljot's above course

Aleksi Partanen – CertiAce

- https://certiace.com/
- Excellent bank of questions for studying

Final Tips

Time Management – you are given only 1 hour and 40 minutes for the exam. The format is case study with questions, along with another section of questions. You can review each section but once you go to the next section, your answers are locked for the previous session. The case study could either be at the front, end, or possibly the middle. I would suggest going to a testing center for a real testing experience rather than taking it online at home. Here is how I divided my time:

- **Case Study** – 25 Minutes – Don't read the whole case study first, go to the question and then scan the Case Study for the answer

- **General Questions** – 60 Minutes – Try not to spend too much time on a single question. If you get stuck, mark it for review and move on. Go with your gut feeling when you answer a question

- **Final Review and Microsoft Learn** – 15 Minutes – The exam is marketed as "open book" but using Microsoft Learn to find the answer is rather difficult. I used those final minutes to review all the questions and one last check. Tip – when you search for something in Learn, go to the filter button, and select Fabric to eliminate the non-Fabric items